



Patch 2.0 for Evo

Samsung is set to release a second set of patches to fix the ongoing performance problems with Evo. <http://dgit.in/EvoPatch>



DNA Vault for data?

Scientists feel that using isolated vaults that can store data on DNA for 2M years in the Arctic are the future. <http://dgit.in/DNAData>

Q&A

Upgrading your ailing desktop? On the lookout for better battery life? We're here to help...

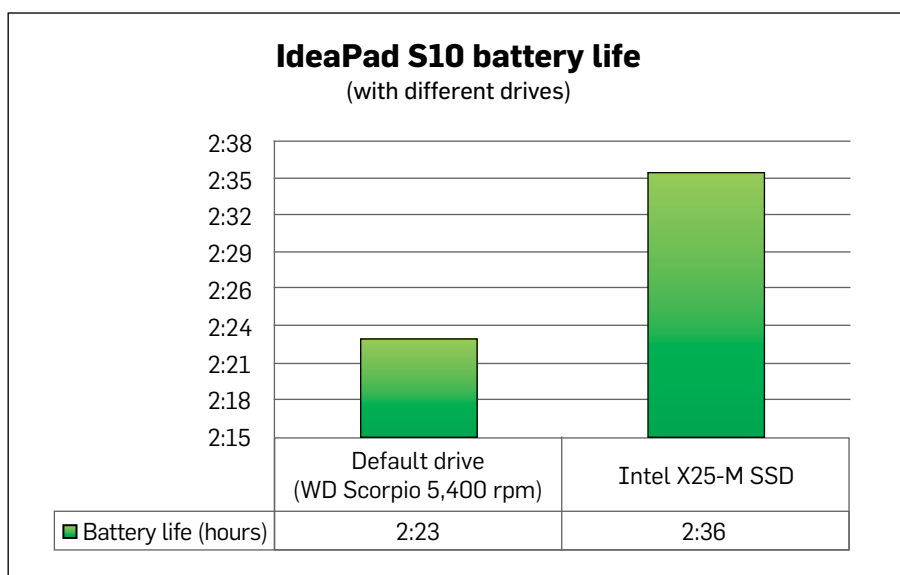
If you're stuck in the technology equivalent of a rock and a hard place, relax, stop struggling. Fire up your PC and shoot off a mail to us and we'll gladly swoop in and save the day!

SSD power draw

I use an HP laptop for my work and I travel a lot so I care much more about the battery life of my laptop than the storage space it has to offer. This is the primary reason why I wanted to shift to an SSD from an HDD and so I'm thinking of buying one with at least 256GB capacity which would be sufficient enough for my work. In order to select a good SSD, I read a few reviews of popular SSDs but none of the reviews (not even manufacturer product pages) mention the minimum or maximum power draw of the SSD in question. Is this because the power draw of SSDs is too insignificant to consider? or is it because a typical 256GB SSD may consume the same amount of power as compared to a 500GB HDD for example?

– Prithvi Bhambri

A As far as the power draw information for SSDs go, it's actually correct that most reviewers don't mention it in their write-up because SSDs consume only a fraction of the power that an HDD does and the power draw is so insignificant as to be irrelevant. An HDD primarily consumes more power because it contains a lot of moving parts, but it is important to note that laptop HDDs are slower than their desktop counterparts and also consume less power. Even in a best case scenario, depending on your usage, an upgrade to an SSD will rarely see you extract more than 30 minutes more from your battery so spending upwards of ₹6,000 on an SSD just for improved battery life may not be justified. That said, an SSD is an ideal storage device for your laptop because it's more secure and doesn't heat up as much as an HDD. It's



HDD vs. SSD - Difference between impact on battery life

worth the upgrade for the massive boost in response time and data security that is inherent in any good SSD.

Poor old system

Hello Team Digit. Me and my family have been using an old Dell XPS 200 desktop running Windows XP for the past several years and it has been serving us really well all this time without giving any trouble. But recently, ever since I heard about Microsoft and how they've dropped support for Windows XP, I also started thinking about newer hardware and upgrading or rebuilding my existing system for want of better performance. If I want to go about upgrading it, will it be possible to buy compatible components and use the same XPS case. If yes, then please suggest the required components for the upgrade along with their price.

– Rahul Vishnoi

A The Dell XPS 200 is based on the Intel Pentium D processor and uses a small form-factor case. Also, since it's a pre-built system, Dell uses a proprietary design for the system, limiting upgradability. Even if you manage to get hold of compatible components, it would be seriously difficult to figure out how to install them in the system and totally not worth the effort. However, if you're hell-bent on upgrading the existing, aging Dell XPS 200, you can add more RAM, throw in an SSD, install Windows 7 and pick up a low-profile GPU like the GTX 750 to improve performance. Although doing this would make your system run faster than it used to be, you should know that the CPU – which in your case happens to be the Pentium D, will be a major bottleneck to your system and severely hamper perceived performance. **d**